found a wife.[224] He married a Muslim convert who also happened to be a former member of the Australian military. Brigitte's now ex-wife has claimed that during their brief union he repeatedly pressed her about her knowledge of the joint US-Australia Pine Gap electronic surveillance base near Alice Springs.[225] Brigitte also remained in contact with his Lashkar handlers and it appears that both he and Lodhi were calling Sajid Mir in Pakistan during this time.[226]

When the Australian police raided Brigitte's apartment, they found internet downloads of chemical compositions that could be used to create explosives. They also found downloads of the Lucas Heights nuclear reactor along with map references to the Garden Island naval base, the nearby Maritime Headquarters and the Victoria Barracks.[227] During a raid of Lodhi's home, they discovered he possessed a map of the Electricity Supply System, was in the process of ordering chemicals to make explosives and also had recorded the ingredients for making various types of bombs.[228] Australian security officials believe that Brigitte and Lodhi intended to select a suitable target and purchase the chemicals necessary to build a large bomb, but that they were planning to bring in a foreign explosives expert to assemble it. Brigitte told French investigators that Lodhi wanted him to host an unnamed guest, and that when he inquired as to the identity of this mystery man, Lodhi 'made it clear, through gestures, that he [the guest] was an explosives expert.'[229] There were reports that this explosives expert worked in Lashkar's camps, but whether he was a member of the group or a freelancer who contracted out his services is unknown.[230]

Australia's contribution to the invasions of Afghanistan and Iraq is believed to have been the motive factor, but it is unclear who generated the plot. According to the French dossier on Brigitte, and confirmed by a former Australian security official, Lodhi was the head of a clandestine cell that was preparing attacks in several countries. This cell was not homogeneous, however, meaning a number of its members were not linked to Lashkar.[231] It is possible Lodhi was directed to launch the attack in Australia, though equally plausible is that he developed the idea and that Lashkar acted as a force multiplier by deploying Brigitte and possibly the explosives expert. Sajid Mir worked directly for Abdul Rehman Makki, who was the head of the External Affairs Department as well as Hafiz